

Standard Operating Procedure

Chemotherapy and Radiopharmaceutical Handling

«Hospital Name» — Supports MOM.9.b, MOM.9.c, MOM.9.d, MOM.9.e (chemotherapy/radiopharmaceuticals)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» prepares and handles chemotherapy and radiopharmaceutical agents safely, protecting both patients and staff.

2. Scope

Applies to every chemotherapy and radiopharmaceutical agent prepared or administered at the hospital.

3. Responsibility

Medical Oncologist / Authorised Prescriber: prescribes with demonstrated competency in the relevant agent.

Trained Onco-Pharmacist / Authorised Caregiver: prepares and administers using required safety equipment.

4. Procedure

4.1 Chemotherapy

1. Confirm the prescriber has demonstrated knowledge and competency in chemotherapy — preferably a medical oncologist.
2. Prepare chemotherapy only in a Class II biosafety cabinet (preferably Class IIA), with appropriate personal protective equipment.
3. Confirm preparation staff have received special training in hazardous drug handling before assigning them to this duty.
4. Handle chemotherapy waste and spills per the hospital's hazardous-drug procedure, referencing the current NIOSH hazardous drug classification for the agent.

4.2 Radiopharmaceuticals

1. Confirm the caregiver preparing or administering a radiopharmaceutical is authorised under applicable AERB regulations.
2. Store and label radiopharmaceuticals per regulatory requirements, with radiation shielding appropriate to the isotope.

4.3 Disposal

1. Dispose of chemotherapy and radiopharmaceutical waste per applicable statutory requirements, keeping the two waste streams separate.

5. Records

Supported by Records 2, 4, and 6 of the MOM.9 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_MOM_9_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — MOM.9 policy
- SOP — Narcotic and Psychotropic Drug Handling (MOM.9)

7. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any chemotherapy spill or preparation-related exposure incident.

8. References

- National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health (NIOSH), Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2024). NIOSH List of Hazardous Drugs in Healthcare Settings, 2024. <https://www.cdc.gov/niosh/publications/hcp/numbered/2025-103.html>
- Atomic Energy Regulatory Board, Government of India. (2004). Atomic Energy (Radiation Protection) Rules, 2004. <https://www.aerb.gov.in/images/PDF/RPR2004-with-corrigendum.pdf>